



Live Project Briefs

Private Equity & Venture Capital Analyst

1 project curated for the Finance track.

Role	Private Equity & Venture Capital Analyst
Projects	1

A light, structured handbook for understanding expectations, planning work, and preparing the final live project submission.



PROJECT TOOLKIT

Live Project Guidelines

Core guidance students should review before working on any live project.

General Guidelines for Live Projects

1. **Individual or Group Participation:** Students may complete the project individually or form a group of up to **four (4) members**. Group formation is entirely at the students' discretion; however, **all group members must belong to the same college/institution**.
2. **Weekly Project Reviews:** Students are expected to attend and follow the instructions, guidance, and action items shared by the Project Manager during the weekly live project review sessions.
3. **Self-Paced Learning:** This is a **self-paced Live Project**, and no strict weekly deadlines have been assigned to accommodate students' academic commitments. However, students are strongly encouraged to maintain consistent progress and actively participate throughout the project to maximize their learning experience.
4. **Recommended Time Commitment:** Students should dedicate approximately **2-3 hours per week** to successfully complete the project and achieve the intended learning outcomes.
5. **Project Report Submission:** Upon completion of the project, students must prepare a comprehensive **Project Report** in either **Microsoft Word (.doc/.docx)** or **PowerPoint (.ppt/.pptx)** format for evaluation. There is **no prescribed page or slide limit**. Students are encouraged to demonstrate originality and creativity by designing their own report structure and presentation format.
6. **Project Completion & Certificate:** There is **no fixed deadline** for submitting the Live Project report. Students may submit their project at any time after completing all the required work. Upon successful evaluation, the **Live Project Completion Certificate** will generally be issued within **3-4 working days**.
7. **Project Selection:** Students may choose **any one of the available Live Projects**. Those enrolled in multiple project roles may either work on all projects simultaneously or complete them sequentially, based on their convenience.
8. **Group Submission Policy:** For group projects, all team members must work on a common project report. However, **each member is required to submit the report individually through their own LMS account** to be eligible for evaluation and certification.
9. **Submission Process:** **All project submissions will be accepted exclusively through the LMS Portal**. Reports submitted via email, WhatsApp, Google Drive links, or any other platform will **not** be considered for evaluation.



PROJECT TOOLKIT

How to Start your Project (4-week Framework)

Suggested weekly rhythm for planning, analysis, drafting, and final submission.

Week-wise Roadmap for Live Project Completion**Important Note**

The following roadmap is a **recommended four-week learning framework** designed to help students approach the Live Project in a structured and industry-oriented manner.

Since this is a **self-paced project**, students who wish to complete the project earlier are welcome to do so. However, they are **strongly advised to follow the same sequence of activities (Week 01 -> Week 02 & 03 -> Week 04)** to ensure a systematic learning experience.

Students may accelerate the pace of execution but **should not skip or rearrange any stage of the project workflow**, as each phase builds the foundation for the next.

Week 01 - Market Research & Company Understanding**Objective**

The objective of Week 1 is to develop a comprehensive understanding of the company, industry, customers, and business environment before beginning the project execution.

1. Project Selection

- Review the list of available Live Projects under your selected role.
- Select one project that you wish to work on as your Live Project.

2. Company & Market Research

Conduct detailed research on the company from multiple functional perspectives to develop cross-functional business thinking. This will help you understand how different business functions contribute to solving real-world problems.

Your research should include:

- Understanding the company's objectives and core offerings
- Company Analysis
- Product & Service Analysis



- Website Analysis
- Website User Experience (UX) Analysis
- Customer Segment Analysis
- Competitor Analysis

3. Business Framework Analysis

Based on your research findings, apply relevant business and strategic frameworks to understand the company's current position and future opportunities.

Suggested frameworks include:

- SWOT Analysis
- PESTEL Analysis
- Ansoff Matrix
- Any other relevant strategic framework applicable to your project

4. Digital Landscape Research

Evaluate the company's online presence and digital positioning by conducting research on:

- Official website and digital assets
- Social media platforms
- Brand visibility and customer engagement
- Existing marketing strategies
- Competitor social media analysis
- Market gaps and potential opportunities

Week 02 & Week 03 - Project Execution & Deliverables

Objective

The objective of this phase is to solve the assigned business problem by applying your research findings and analytical skills.

Students should:

- Work on the project objectives and deliverables specified for their selected Live Project.
- Perform additional market research wherever required.



- Conduct data analysis and interpret findings.
- Brainstorm and evaluate multiple solution approaches.
- Develop practical, research-backed recommendations.
- Continuously refine the project based on insights generated throughout the execution phase.

This stage should focus on demonstrating:

- Problem-solving ability
- Strategic thinking
- Practical business recommendations

Week 04 - Final Recommendations & Project Report Submission

Objective

The final week should focus on consolidating all your work into a professional project report.

Students should:

- Prepare the final project report in either **Microsoft Word (.doc/.docx)** or **PowerPoint (.ppt/.pptx)** format.
- Organize the report in a logical and professional manner.
- Compile all research findings, analyses, project outcomes, and supporting evidence.
- Present actionable business recommendations and implementation strategies.
- Review and proofread the report before submission through the **LMS Portal**.

The final report should clearly demonstrate:

- Research methodology
- Analytical thinking
- Business understanding
- Recommendations
- Overall project outcomes



PRIVATE EQUITY & VENTURE CAPITAL ANALYST

Project Details

Project 1

Private Equity & Venture Capital Analyst

Company	Caplexus Capital
Role Category	Finance

Project Brief

As an Investment Analyst at **Caplexus Capital**, you will evaluate a real-world style investment opportunity and prepare the same deliverables that would typically be presented to an Investment Committee before an investment decision is made.

Participants are required to choose **one** of the following investment tracks:

- **Track A - Private Equity:** Evaluate a majority buyout opportunity involving a profitable regional diagnostics company by building a Leveraged Buyout (LBO) model, analysing investment returns, identifying value creation opportunities, and preparing an Investment Committee recommendation.

OR

- **Track B - Venture Capital:** Evaluate a Series A investment opportunity in a high-growth health-tech startup by analysing the market opportunity, business model, unit economics, capitalization table, ownership dilution, exit scenarios, and investment returns before recommending investment terms.

For the selected track, participants will build a professional Excel model supporting their analysis and prepare a concise Investment Committee memorandum summarizing the investment thesis, commercial assessment, financial analysis, valuation, risks, expected returns, and final recommendation.

The objective is not to arrive at a single "correct" answer, but to demonstrate sound investment judgment, analytical rigor, financial modeling capability, and the ability to communicate investment recommendations in a clear, structured, and professional manner.

Objectives

The objective of this live project is to provide participants with hands-on experience in evaluating investment opportunities from the perspective of a Private Equity or Venture Capital investor.

Upon successful completion of this project, participants should be able to:



- Understand the end-to-end investment evaluation process followed by Private Equity and Venture Capital firms.
- Develop a structured investment thesis based on commercial, financial, and strategic analysis.
- Build practical financial models, including Leveraged Buyout (LBO) models or Venture Capital capitalization tables and return models.
- Assess business quality through market analysis, competitive positioning, operating performance, and unit economics.
- Evaluate investment returns using metrics such as IRR, MOIC, ownership dilution, and exit scenarios.
- Analyse key value creation drivers and identify major investment risks.
- Formulate investment recommendations supported by quantitative analysis and qualitative reasoning.
- Prepare professional Investment Committee (IC) memorandums consistent with industry standards.
- Strengthen analytical thinking, financial modeling, valuation, and investment decision-making skills applicable to careers in Private Equity, Venture Capital, Investment Banking, Corporate Finance, and Strategy Consulting.

Action Items

Introduction

The **Private Equity & Venture Capital Live Project** is designed to provide participants with practical exposure to the investment decision-making process followed by Private Equity funds, Venture Capital firms, Growth Equity investors, and Investment Banking professionals.

In this project, participants will assume the role of an Investment Analyst at **Caplexus Capital**, an India-focused investment firm with dedicated Private Equity and Venture Capital investment platforms. Participants will evaluate a live investment opportunity by applying structured investment analysis, financial modeling, valuation techniques, commercial due diligence, and investment judgment to determine whether the proposed investment meets the firm's return expectations and risk criteria.

The project closely mirrors the work performed by analysts and associates in leading investment firms, enabling participants to develop industry-relevant skills in deal evaluation, investment thesis formulation, financial modeling, transaction analysis, and investment committee presentation.

Deliverables

Track A - Private Equity:

The MediCore Buyout Project Scenario

You have joined **Caplexus PE**, the Private Equity investment arm of Caplexus Capital, as an Investment Analyst. The firm is evaluating the acquisition of **MediCore Diagnostics**, a profitable regional diagnostics



chain operating across Western and Central India.

The investment team believes the company presents an attractive **buy-and-build (roll-up)** opportunity within a highly fragmented diagnostics market. Your responsibility is to evaluate whether the proposed leveraged buyout generates sufficient returns while identifying the key value creation opportunities and investment risks.

Your Analysis Should Cover¹.

Investment Opportunity Assessment

Evaluate whether the proposed acquisition is financially attractive by analysing:

- Appropriate entry valuation
- Enterprise Value negotiation range
- Suitable debt financing structure
- Optimal leverage (Debt / EBITDA multiple)
- Acquisition funding mix

2. Leveraged Buyout (LBO) Model

Build a fully functional **5-year Leveraged Buyout (LBO) Model** in Microsoft Excel.

Your model should include:

- Purchase Price Allocation
- Sources & Uses of Funds
- Debt Schedule
- Interest Calculations
- Mandatory Debt Repayment
- Free Cash Flow Sweep
- Operating Forecast
- Exit Assumptions
- Equity Value Bridge

The model should be dynamic, formula-driven, and allow assumptions to be changed easily.

3. Investment Return Analysis



Calculate expected investment returns including:

- Internal Rate of Return (IRR)
- Multiple on Invested Capital (MOIC)
- Equity Value at Exit
- Enterprise Value at Exit

Develop both:

- Base Case Scenario
- Downside Case Scenario (lower growth and/or lower exit multiple)

Compare the impact on investor returns.

4. Value Creation Analysis

Analyse the key drivers responsible for value creation.

Quantify the contribution from:

- EBITDA Growth
- Debt Reduction (Deleveraging)
- Exit Multiple Expansion

Identify and explain at least **3-4 operational initiatives** that could improve business performance, including the proposed buy-and-build strategy through acquisitions of smaller regional laboratories.

5. Investment Recommendation

Based on your analysis, recommend whether Caplexus PE should proceed with the investment.

Your recommendation should clearly justify:

- Go / No-Go decision
- Maximum acquisition price that still achieves a minimum **20% IRR**
- Key investment strengths
- Major investment risks
- Suggested risk mitigation strategies

Final Deliverables (Track A) Microsoft Excel Model



The Excel workbook should include:

- LBO Model
- Operating Forecast
- Debt Schedule
- Return Analysis
- Scenario Analysis
- Sensitivity Analysis
- Supporting Assumptions

Investment Committee (IC) Memorandum

Prepare a professional **Investment Committee Memo (Maximum 2 Pages)** covering:

- Investment Thesis
- Company Overview
- Transaction Summary
- Financial Analysis
- Expected Returns
- Value Creation Plan
- Key Risks
- Final Investment Recommendation

Track B:

Venture Capital: The PathPin Series A Project Scenario

You have joined **Caplexus Ventures**, the Venture Capital investment arm of Caplexus Capital, as an Investment Analyst.

The firm is evaluating a **Series A investment** in **PathPin**, a fast-growing health-tech startup providing at-home diagnostics, AI-powered report interpretation, and teleconsultation services.

Your objective is to evaluate whether PathPin has the characteristics of a venture-scale business capable of generating attractive investment returns.



Your Analysis Should Cover

1. Market Opportunity Assessment

Conduct a comprehensive market assessment covering:

- Total Addressable Market (TAM)
- Serviceable Available Market (SAM)
- Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)
- Industry Growth Drivers
- Competitive Landscape
- Market Positioning
- Venture Scale Opportunity

2. Business Quality Assessment

Evaluate the overall quality of the business by analysing:

- Founding Team
- Product Offering
- Customer Value Proposition
- Revenue Growth
- Unit Economics
- Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)
- Lifetime Value (LTV)
- Burn Rate
- Cash Runway
- Competitive Advantages
- Defensibility

3. Capitalization Table Analysis

Prepare a complete **Post-Money Capitalization Table** including:

- Existing Shareholding Structure
- Series A Investment



- Option Pool Expansion
- Founder Ownership
- Investor Ownership
- Dilution Analysis

4. Return Analysis

Model multiple exit scenarios, including:

- IPO Exit
- Strategic Acquisition (M&A)

Estimate:

- Exit Enterprise Value
- Investor Ownership
- Multiple on Invested Capital (MOIC)
- Fund-Level Return Impact

5. Investment Terms

Recommend an appropriate investment structure including:

- Pre-money Valuation
- Post-money Valuation
- Investment Amount
- Ownership Percentage
- Liquidation Preference
- ESOP Pool
- Board Representation
- Other important term sheet provisions

Support all recommendations with logical reasoning.

6. Investment Recommendation

Based on your complete analysis, recommend whether Caplexus Ventures should invest in PathPin.



Clearly explain:

- Invest / Pass Decision
- Recommended Valuation
- Target Ownership
- Investment Thesis
- Key Risks
- Potential Upside

Final Deliverables (Track B) Microsoft Excel Workbook

The workbook should include:

- Capitalization Table
- Ownership Dilution Analysis
- Exit Return Analysis
- MOIC Calculations
- Scenario Analysis
- Supporting Assumptions

Investment Memorandum

Prepare a professional **Investment Memo (Maximum 2 Pages)** covering:

- Market Opportunity
- Company Overview
- Product & Business Assessment
- Team Evaluation
- Traction Analysis
- Proposed Investment Terms
- Return Scenarios
- Key Risks
- Final Investment Recommendation